

CloudWalk Sourcing Analysis: Patterns, Conversion & Recruiter Intelligence

1. Approach

This analysis was built on a fictional sourcing dataset of 601 candidates across 6 recruiters, 8 source channels, and 4 seniority levels. The goal was to move beyond surface-level funnel metrics and surface actionable patterns that help recruiters make better decisions — faster.

The analysis was structured around the five core questions posed in the challenge:

- *Which sourcing strategies convert best?*
- *What signals indicate a higher chance of advancing?*
- *When is it worth persisting with a candidate?*
- *When is there a low probability of conversion?*
- *Are there relevant patterns among channels, recruiters, or profiles?*

AI Claude was used throughout the process as a thinking partner and analysis accelerator: from data exploration to pattern recognition, hypothesis stress-testing, and insight structuring.

2. Funnel Overview

Stage	Count	% of Total
Sourced	601	100.00%
Responded	408	67.90%
Screening Pass	308	51.20%
Interview 1 Pass	234	38.90%
Test Taken	201	33.40%
Offer Sent	62	10.30%
Hired	49	8.20%

Post-test evaluation includes behavior and manager assessments, however, the dataset does not capture pass/fail flags for these stages, only scores. This is itself a data quality finding: without structured gates, it's impossible to measure drop-off at each assessment layer.

3. Which Sourcing Strategies Convert Best?

Channel	Candidates	Hired	Hire Rate	Response Rate
Github	73	8	11%	68.5%
Inbound	69	7	10.1%	79.7%
Hunting	75	7	9.3%	64.0%
Talent Pool	68	6	8.8%	75.0%
LinkedIn	81	7	8.6%	63.0%
Communities	89	7	7.9%	67.4%
Events	82	4	4.9%	67.1%
Referrals	64	3	4.7%	59.4%

Key insights:

- Github and Inbound are the strongest channels: candidates found via technical platforms are more likely to close;
- Inbound has the highest response rate (79.7%): actively interested candidates engage more;
- Referrals is the worst performing channel with a 4.7% hire rate and the lowest response rate (59.4%). This suggests referrals may be over-trusted at two levels: recruiters may skip screening rigor assuming the referral signal is enough, and referred candidates themselves may approach the process with less preparation and urgency, assuming the internal recommendation carries more weight than it does;
- LinkedIn generates the most outreach but underdelivers on both engagement and conversion.

4. What Signals Indicate a Higher Chance of Advancing?

Score Threshold (Hired vs Not Hired) - Scores on a 0-100 scale

Stage / Interview	Hired	Not Hired
Technical Test	82.4	72.9
Behavior	80.1	74.0
Manager	80.9	73.1

Data suggests a soft threshold around 75 across all three dimensions; candidates clearing this bar show an **82.6% offer rate**. However, this is not a hard gate: when one dimension scores low, the other two tend to score significantly higher among candidates who still received offers, assuming that this reflects a holistic debrief model rather than hard per-dimension gates.

Recruiter notes reveal additional behavioral signals beyond structured scores.

Candidates flagged as having strong communication and fast response converted at 11.5%, reinforcing that engagement quality early in the process is a reliable predictor. Candidates noted as having high salary expectations showed a 14% hire rate (the highest among all note categories) suggesting these are typically stronger, more senior profiles worth pursuing despite compensation complexity.

On the other end, notes like 'strong role fit' (1.7%) and 'growth potential' (3.6%) correlate with poor conversion, likely reflecting candidates who present well on paper but underperform at the assessment stage, or are not yet ready for the level. 'Positive manager feedback' converting at only 5.8% points to a recurring misalignment between manager enthusiasm and final offer decisions.

One candidate (ID 601) presents scores outside the expected 0-100 range: technical 118, behavior 12, manager 104; a likely data entry error. This candidate received an offer and was hired, suggesting the decision was made despite (or without awareness of) the scoring inconsistency. **Score validation rules (min 0, max 100) should be enforced at the ATS level to prevent data integrity issues.**

5. When Is It Worth Persisting With a Candidate?

Of the 185 candidates who passed Interview 1 but were not hired, 46 exited for purely external reasons: timing mismatch, headcount closure, salary mismatch, or accepting another offer. These are not rejection signals. They are pipeline assets.

The highest-priority group to keep warm: the 8 candidates who cleared a ≥ 75 score across all three assessment dimensions but did not receive an offer. Every single one of them was lost to timing or headcount, not fit. These profiles already passed the most selective gate in the funnel and should be the first call when a relevant role opens.

A secondary persist signal is stage duration: candidates who remained actively engaged across multiple process stages before exiting for external reasons demonstrated sustained interest - a behavioral indicator that their motivation was genuine, not passive.

Recruiter notes for this group also offer a practical filter. 'High salary expectations' appeared 6 times among external exits, consistent with the broader finding that these candidates have a 14% hire rate overall. Compensation complexity alone should not disqualify a strong profile, but it requires an honest early conversation about range alignment. If expectations are significantly

above the band, the calculus changes; the goal is to avoid investing in a full process only to lose at the offer stage on a gap that was visible from the start.

6. When Is There a Low Probability of Conversion?

High drop-off combinations:

- Junior + Referral - 0% hire rate (0 of 7 candidates hired);
- Candidates with a technical score below 70 - 0% hire rate across 221 candidates;

No-response rate by channel:

- Referral: 42.2%
- LinkedIn: 40.7%
- Community: 37.1%
- Hunting: 36.0%
- Github: 35.6%
- Event: 32.9%
- Talent pool: 29.4%
- Inbound: 24.6%

No response accounts for 210 of 375 logged rejections; the biggest pipeline killer. This is a sourcing quality and outreach personalization problem, not a volume problem.

Data quality note: 226 of 552 non-hired candidates have no rejection reason logged; 41% of exits are untracked. Without this data, pattern analysis is incomplete and pipeline learnings are lost. Mandatory rejection reason capture should be enforced in the ATS.

7. Patterns Among Channels, Recruiters & Profiles / Roles

Recruiter	Total Candidates	Hired	Hire Rate
Bruno	98	15	15.30%
Ana	75	10	13.30%
Carla	101	9	8.90%
Gustavo	121	6	5.00%
Diego	103	5	4.90%
Fernanda	103	4	3.90%

Volume ≠ performance:

Gustavo sources the most (121) but ranks 5th in hire rate (5%);
Ana sources the fewest (75) and ranks 2nd in hire rate (13.3%).

Recruiter x Seniority Hire Rate:

Recruiter	Junior	Pleno	Senior	Staff
Ana	0%	12.10%	13.60%	37.50%
Bruno	4.80%	16.10%	19.40%	20.00%
Carla	0%	5.40%	17.60%	10.00%
Diego	5.90%	7.50%	2.90%	0%
Fernanda	6.70%	2.50%	5.30%	0%
Gustavo	8.30%	2.10%	2.60%	18.20%

Key patterns:

- Ana is exceptional at Staff level (37.5%): stronger at consultative, senior-level engagement;
- Bruno is consistently strong across all levels: the most versatile recruiter;
- Diego and Fernanda collapse at senior and staff levels;

Insight: Allocating recruiters by seniority fit could meaningfully improve overall conversion.

Role-Level Patterns:

Hire rate varies significantly by role:

Role-Level Patterns			
Role	Total	Hired	Hire Rate
Analista de Recrutamento	147	17	11.60%
People BP	165	14	8.50%
Analista de Dados	162	11	6.80%
Talent Acquisition Specialist	127	7	5.50%

The strongest role-channel combination in the entire dataset:

- *Analista de Recrutamento sourced via Github converts at 26.7%; more than 3x the overall average.*
- *Analista de Recrutamento via Talent Pool follows at 21.1%, suggesting this role responds particularly well to candidates with prior visibility into the company or strong*

technical platform presence.

- *Junior-level candidates show 0% hire rate across 3 of 4 roles - the only exception is Analista de Recrutamento Junior, which converts at 18.5%. This suggests Junior hiring is only viable for specific roles, and sourcing effort at Junior level should be concentrated accordingly rather than applied uniformly across all requisitions.*

8. How AI Was Applied?

1. Data Exploration: Claude ran initial exploratory analysis identifying funnel structure, column types, and candidate distribution.
2. Pattern Recognition: AI surfaced non-obvious patterns: referral underperformance, recruiter-seniority interaction, stage duration signal, and score threshold.
3. Hypothesis Stress-Testing: Claude cross-validated hypotheses, e.g. whether high-volume recruiters had harder requisitions, or whether no-response was channel-specific.
4. Narrative & Communication: AI structured the analysis into a coherent, actionable narrative for a recruiting audience.

AI was used as a thinking partner and analyst accelerator, not as a replacement for judgment. Every insight was validated against raw data and interpreted through the lens of recruiting practice.

9. Key Insights Summary:

1. Github and Inbound outperform all other channels: technical platform presence has measurable ROI;
2. Referrals underperform expectations: 4.7% hire rate, lowest of all channels;
3. No response accounts for 210 of 375 logged rejections; the biggest pipeline killer. Outreach personalization problem, not a volume problem;
4. Technical score above 75 is the clearest hiring predictor;
5. Stage duration is a positive signal: among candidates who passed screening, hired candidates stay in process nearly 2x longer than non-hired;
6. Recruiter performance is level-dependent: aligning recruiters to seniority strengths could improve outcomes without changing headcount;
7. Volume sourcing inflates the pipeline without improving conversion.

10. Practical Recommendations for Recruiters:

1. Prioritize Github and Inbound over mass LinkedIn outreach;
2. Treat no-response as a quality signal: personalize outreach, don't increase volume.
3. Use the 75-point threshold as an early decision signal with hiring managers.
4. Build a warm pipeline from timing/headcount rejects - they are the highest-probability future hires.
5. Align recruiter assignments to seniority strengths; route senior/staff roles to Bruno and Ana.
6. Audit the referral process: add a structured evaluation step before referrals enter the pipeline to avoid moving forward with any referral candidate just because it is coming from this channel;
7. Consider repositioning the technical assessment before Interview 1 for high-volume requisitions, particularly at Junior and Pleno levels. A common concern is that early assessments reduce candidate engagement, however, this can be mitigated with strong candidate communications that clearly explain the process, set expectations for the assessment, and commit to timely feedback regardless of outcome. When done well, an early test respects the candidate's time as much as the recruiter's. At Senior and Staff levels, the recruiter conversation should come first; relationship and context matter more at that stage, and a cold assessment early in the process risks losing high-value passive candidates.